

Audience Analysis

Week 3

Contents

- Audience Recognition
- Issues of Diversity,
- Multiculturalism
- Biased Language
- Audience Involvement

1. Audience Recognition

Questions to consider

- ❖ Who is your audience?
- ❖ What does this reader or listener know?
- ❖ What does this reader or listener not know?
- ❖ What must you write or say to ensure that your audience understands your point?
- ❖ How do you communicate to more than one person (multiple audiences)?
- ❖ What is this person's position in relation to your job title?
- ❖ What diversity issues (gender, sexual orientation, cultural, multicultural) must
you consider?

Audience Variables

<i>Knowledge of Subject Matter</i>	<i>Personality Traits</i>	<i>Issues of Diversity</i>
High tech	Audience's perceived personality	Age
Low tech	Audience's attitude or position regarding the topic	Gender
Lay	Audience's preference regarding style	Race/ or religion
Multiple	Audience's response to the topic	Sexual Orientation
		Language and/or culture of origin - multicultural or cross cultural

Experts/ High-Tech Audience

- Work in your field of expertise
- Share your educational background, work experience and level of understanding
- Writing tips:
 - 1) Require minimal details regarding standard procedure or theories of the field.
 - 2) Require minimal background information of the project

Low-tech Audience

- Familiar with the area of your expertise but only superficially/ at peripheral
- Are familiar with your subject matter and understand some jargons & abbreviations
- Writing tips:
 - 1) Define abbreviations parenthetically; BCA (Burst Cutting Area)
 - 2) Use follow-up explanations
 - 3) Define technical terms by giving ample information
 - 4) Provide more background information.

Lay Audience

- No knowledge of your field of expertise and terminology
- Includes customers/ clients
- Writing tips:
 - 1) Simplify things for the readers
 - 2) Explain clearly through precise word usage, depth of details and simple graphics.
 - 3) Avoid high-tech jargons
 - 4) Need background information

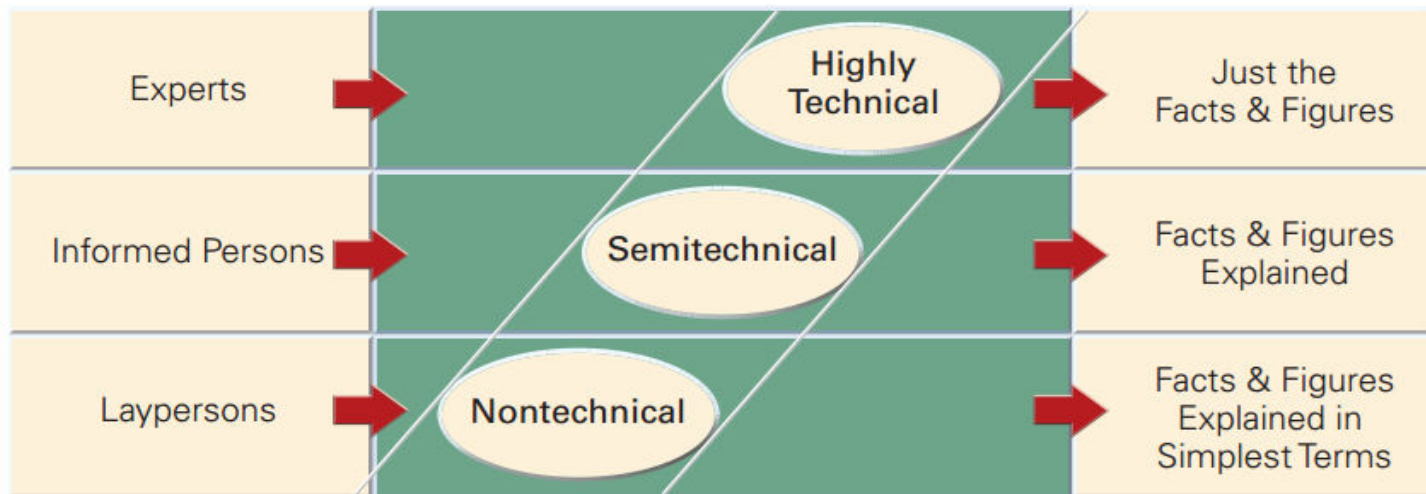
How to communicate to different level of audience

Audience	How to communicate	Sample
High-Tech	Use jargon, acronym, or abbreviation alone	The wastewater is being treated for DBPs.
Low-Tech	Use jargon, acronym, or abbreviation with parenthetical definition	The wastewater is being treated for DBPs (disinfection by-products).
Lay	Use jargon, acronym, or abbreviation with a parenthetical definition and a brief explanation or extended definition.	The wastewater is being treated for DBPs (disinfection by-products), such as acid, methane, chlorine, and ammonia.

**"Who will use
the document?"**

**"At what level
of technicality?"**

**"How much do
these readers
need?"**



Example-High Tech

The patient was brought to the ER by ambulance at 1:00 A.M., September 27, 2010. The patient complained of severe chest pains, dyspnea, and vertigo. Auscultation and EKG revealed a massive cardiac infarction and pulmonary edema marked by pronounced cyanosis. Vital signs: blood pressure, 80/40; pulse, 140/min; respiration, 35/min. Lab: wbc, 20,000; elevated serum transaminase; urea nitrogen, 60 mg%. Urinalysis showed 4+ protein and 4+ granular casts/field, indicating acute renal failure secondary to the hypotension.

Example-Low Tech

Examination by stethoscope and electrocardiogram revealed a massive failure of the heart muscle along with fluid buildup in the lungs, which produced a cyanotic discoloration of the lips and fingertips from lack of oxygen.

The patient's blood pressure at 80 mm Hg (systolic)/40 mm Hg (diastolic) was dangerously below its normal measure of 130/70. A pulse rate of 140/minute was almost twice the normal rate of 60–80. Respiration at 35/minute was more than twice the normal rate of 12–16.

Example-Lay

Heart sounds and electrical impulses were both abnormal, indicating a massive heart attack caused by failure of a large part of the heart muscle. The lungs were swollen with fluid and the lips and fingertips showed a bluish discoloration from lack of oxygen.

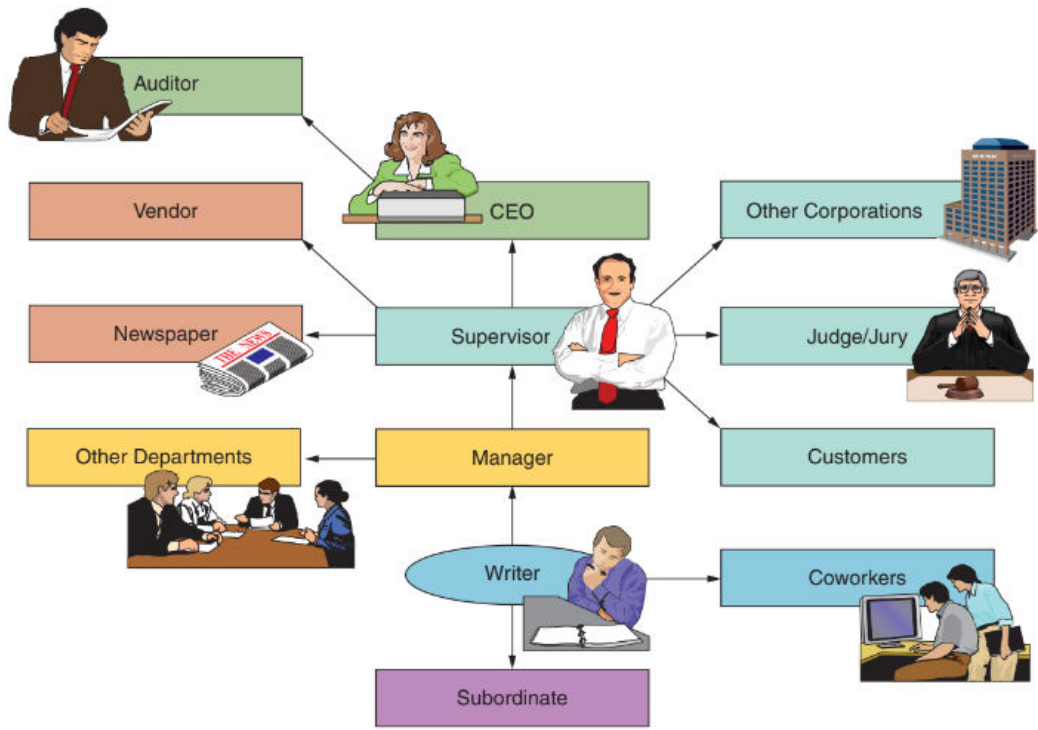
Blood pressure was dangerously low, creating the risk of shock. Pulse and respiration were almost twice the normal rate, indicating that the heart and lungs were being overworked in keeping oxygenated blood circulating freely.

Multiple audience

Audience with different backgrounds and levels of expertise.

Writing tips:

1. Give proper background data (objectives/overviews) to clarify history
2. Define each jargon, abbreviations and acronyms



Future Audience

- Sending old proposal to a new client
- New employee retrieving files to learn how to accomplish a task
- Accountants and auditors looking at old record
- New supervisors or managers who want to familiarize themselves with work
- Technicians who need to implement current procedures based on past findings
- Writing tips:

Clear, well defined explanations and ample background information

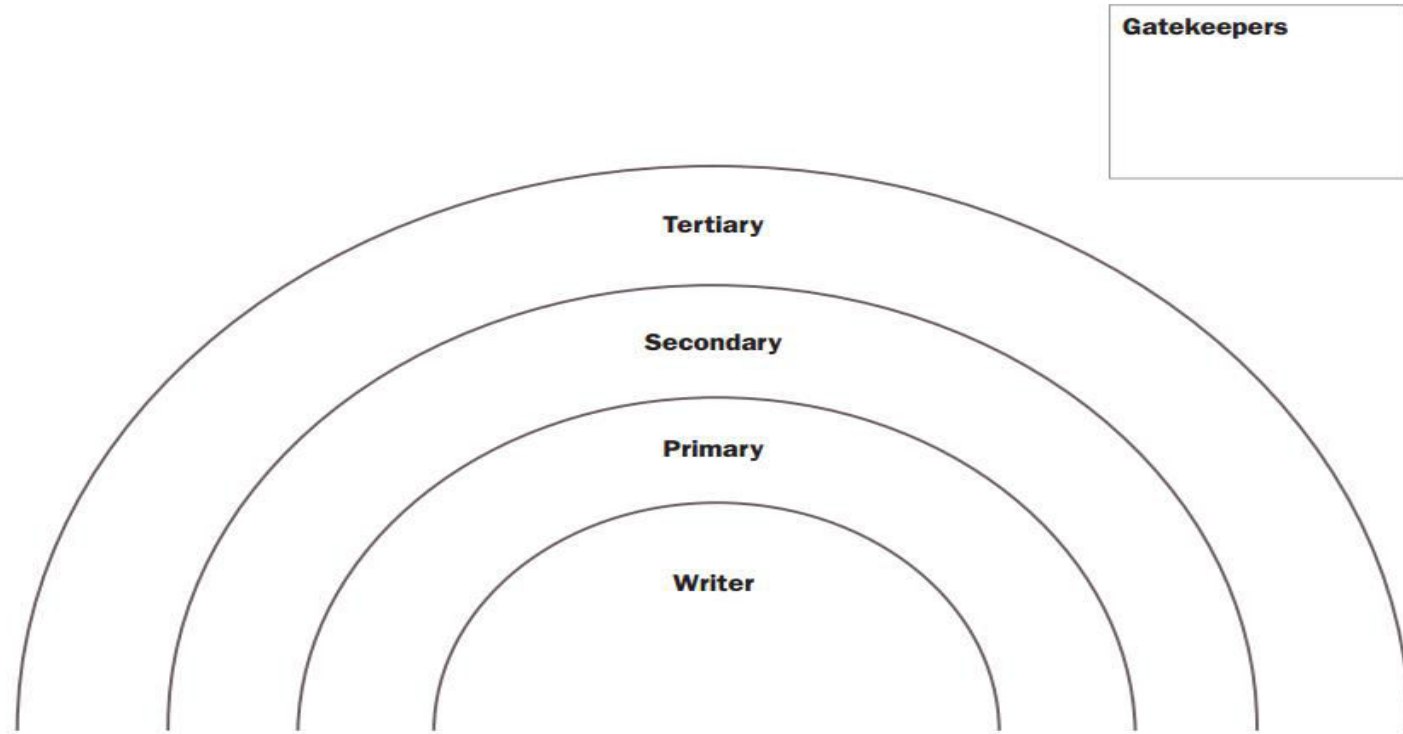
1.1 Audience Profiling

Creating an audience profile

- Identify your readers:
 - Primary readers (action takers)
 - Secondary Readers (advisors)
 - Tertiary readers (evaluators)
 - Gatekeepers (supervisors)

Figure 2.1 Writer-Centered Analysis Worksheet

A Writer-Centered Analysis Worksheet starts with you in the center and identifies the various people who may be interested in your document.



Audience's needs, values & attitudes

- Familiarity with the subject (high/low-tech, lay)
- Experience
- Comprehension level

Figure 2.2 Reader Analysis Worksheet

To better understand your readers, fill in this Reader Analysis Worksheet with notes about their characteristics.

Readers	Needs	Values	Attitudes
Primary			
Secondary			
Tertiary			
Gatekeepers			

Audience's personality traits

Audience's perceived personality

- Slow to act?
 - Eager?
 - Receptive?
 - Questioning?
 - Organized?
 - Disorganized?
 - Oppositional?
-

Audience's preference regarding style

- Will he, she, or they accept contractions?
 - Should you use first names, last names, or position titles?
 - Is short and to-the-point better?
 - Is long and detailed better?
-

Audience's attitude or position regarding the topic

- Negative?
- Positive?
- Noncommittal?
- Informed?
- Uninformed?

Desired audience response

- Do you want the audience to consider this idea and pass on a recommendation?
 - Do you want the audience to act now?
 - Do you want the audience to confirm what has been suggested?
 - Do you want the audience to reject some options but act on others?
 - Do you want the audience to file this information for future reference?
-

Identify the context

	Physical Context	Mobile Context	Economic Context	Ethical Context
Primary Readers				
Readers' Company				
Readers' Industry				

West Nile Virus (WNV) Fact Sheet

What Is West Nile Virus?

West Nile virus infection can cause serious disease. WNV is established as a seasonal epidemic in North America that flares up in the summer and continues into the fall. This fact sheet contains important information that can help you recognize and prevent West Nile virus.

What Can I Do to Prevent WNV?

The easiest and best way to avoid WNV is to prevent mosquito bites.

- When outdoors, use repellents containing DEET, picaridin, IR3535, some oil of lemon eucalyptus or para-menthane-diol. Follow the directions on the package.
- Many mosquitoes are most active from dusk to dawn. Be sure to use insect repellent and wear long sleeves and pants at these times or consider staying indoors during these hours.
- Make sure you have good screens on your windows and doors to keep mosquitoes out.
- Get rid of mosquito breeding sites by emptying standing water from flower pots, buckets and barrels. Change the water in pet dishes and replace the water in bird baths weekly. Drill holes in tire swings so water drains out. Keep children's wading pools empty and on their sides when they aren't being used.

What Are the Symptoms of WNV?

- **Serious Symptoms in a Few People.** About 1 in 150 people infected with WNV will develop severe illness. The severe symptoms can include high fever, headache, neck stiffness, stupor, disorientation, coma, tremors, convulsions, muscle weakness, vision loss, numbness and paralysis. These symptoms may last several weeks, and neurological effects may be permanent.
- **Milder Symptoms in Some People.** Up to 20 percent of the people who become infected will have symptoms which can include fever, headache, body aches, nausea, vomiting, and sometimes swollen lymph glands or a skin rash on the chest, stomach and back. Symptoms can last for as short as a few days to as long as several weeks.
- **No Symptoms in Most People.** Approximately 80 percent of people who are infected with WNV will not show any symptoms at all, but there is no way to know in advance if you will develop an illness or not.

How Does West Nile Virus Spread?

- **Infected Mosquitoes.** WNV is spread by the bite of an infected mosquito. Mosquitoes become infected when they feed on infected birds. Infected mosquitoes can then spread WNV to humans and other animals when they bite.
- **Transfusions, Transplants, and Mother-to-Child.** In a very small number of cases, WNV also has been spread directly from an infected person through blood transfusions, organ transplants, breastfeeding and during pregnancy from mother to baby.
- **Not through touching.** WNV is not spread through casual contact such as touching or kissing a person with the virus.

How Soon Do Infected People Get Sick?

People typically develop symptoms between 3 and 14 days after they are bitten by the infected mosquito.

How Is WNV Infection Treated?

There is no specific treatment for WNV infection. In cases with milder symptoms, people experience symptoms such as fever and aches that pass on their own, although illness may last weeks to months. In more severe cases, people usually need to go to the hospital where they can receive supportive treatment including intravenous fluids, help with breathing, and nursing care.

What Should I Do if I Think I Have WNV?

Milder WNV illness improves on its own, and people do not need to seek medical attention for this infection though they may choose to do so. If you develop symptoms of severe WNV illness, such as unusually severe headaches or confusion, seek medical attention immediately. Severe WNV illness usually requires hospitalization. Pregnant women and nursing mothers are encouraged to talk to their doctor if they develop symptoms that could be WNV.



Headings help readers find document for information.

Examples are used to illustrate points.

Questions are used to anticipate readers' concerns.

Bulleted lists
help readers
locate
specific
information.

What Is the Risk of Getting Sick from WNV?

- **People over 50 at higher risk to get severe illness.** People over the age of 50 are more likely to develop serious symptoms of WNV if they do get sick and should take special care to avoid mosquito bites.
- **Being outside means you're at risk.** The more time you're outdoors, the more time you could be bitten by an infected mosquito. Pay attention to avoiding mosquito bites if you spend time outside, either working or playing.
- **Risk through medical procedures is very low.** All donated blood is checked for WNV before being used. The risk of getting WNV through blood transfusions and organ transplants is very small, and should not prevent people who need surgery from having it. If you have concerns, talk to your doctor.

What Is CDC Doing About WNV?

CDC is working with state and local health departments, the Food and Drug Administration and other government agencies, as well as private industry, to prepare for and prevent new cases of WNV.

Some things CDC is doing include:

- Coordinating a nation-wide electronic database where states share information about WNV
- Helping states develop and carry out improved mosquito prevention and control programs
- Developing better, faster tests to detect and diagnose WNV
- Creating new education tools and programs for the media, the public, and health professionals
- Working with partners to develop vaccines.



Images
reinforce
written text.



What Else Should I Know?

West Nile virus infects birds. In nature, West Nile virus cycles between mosquitoes and birds. Some infected birds can develop high levels of the virus in their bloodstream and mosquitoes can become infected by biting these infected birds. Some, but not all infected birds get sick and die of disease. One way health officials conduct surveillance for West Nile virus is by testing local birds. Finding dead birds may be a sign that West Nile virus is circulating between birds and the mosquitoes in an area. By reporting dead birds to state and local health departments, you can play an important role in monitoring West Nile virus. State and local agencies have different policies for collecting and testing birds, so check with your county or [state health department](#) to find information about reporting dead birds in your area.

If you find a dead bird: Don't handle the body with your bare hands. Contact your local health department for instructions on reporting and disposing of the body. They may tell you to dispose of the bird after they log your report.

For more information, visit www.cdc.gov/westnile, or call CDC at 800-CDC-INFO (English and Spanish) or 888-232-6348 (TTY).

1.2 Anticipate needs of global reader

Difference in content according to culture

- The Chinese are skeptical of overt attempts to persuade
- In the Middle East negotiation and bargaining is expected even in technical fields
- Norway and Sweden are the opposite of that
- In many Asian cultures reputation or writer and company matter.

Difference in organizations

- Middle-east: documents rely on repetition
- To Americans this is stating the obvious
- In Japan it isn't uncommon for writers to begin letters and emails with contextual information like weather.

Difference in Style

- China: overt persuasion is rude and aggressive.
- Arab cultures: ornamental, florid and formal. Sensory details, metaphors are common
- Mexico and South America: formal writing style. Informal style – lack of respect
- Sub-Saharan Africa: win-win situation. Suspicious of reader benefit only
- Norway & Sweden: self assured and confident

Design Difference

- Europeans think that American documents use too many graphic and white spaces
- Americans find European documents cramped
- In China, official documents and presentations are given in black and white

2. Issues of diversity



Why should we be concerned about diversity?

1. Protected by law
2. Equal opportunity
3. Ethical consideration
4. Diversity is good for business/ Globalization
5. A diverse workforce keeps companies competitive



TRUE MATCH

Your skin has a story.
It's a mosaic of all the faces before it.

WITH 13 SHADES, TRUE MATCH ANALYZES YOUR PERFECT MATCH.
TRUE MATCH HAS AN EXCLUSIVE TECHNOLOGY THAT MATCHES YOUR UNIQUE TONES AND JARVIS'ONES. MEET JUST FROM JARVIS TO JARVIS, BUT MEET TO MEET, THE COOL, YOUR GUARANTEE. **BECAUSE YOUR MOTHER IS IT.** lorealparisusa.com/truematch

Find your shade at lorealparisusa.com/truematch

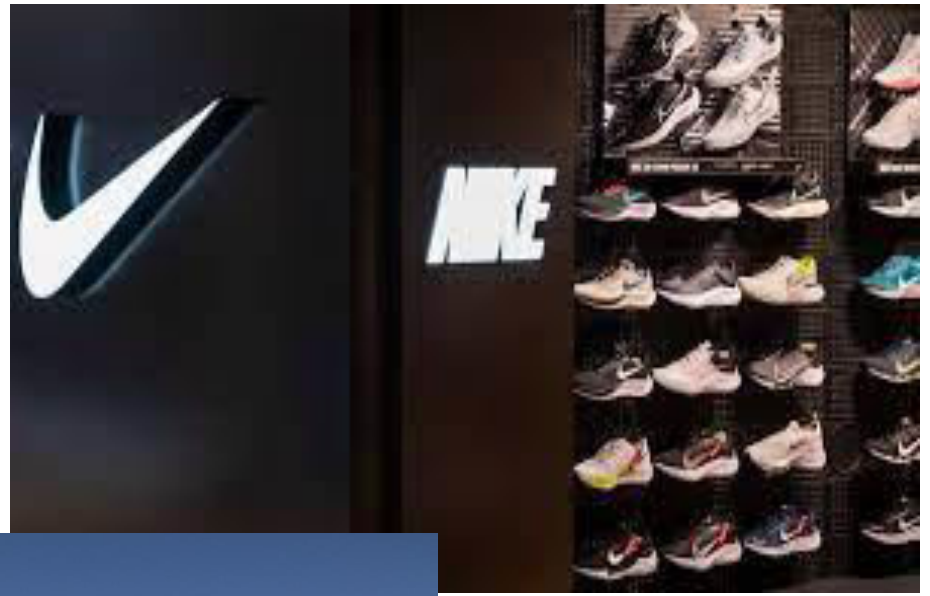
L'ORÉAL
MAKEUP DESIGNER/PARIS



3. Multiculturalism

Multiculturalism

- It is defined as a situation in which all the different cultural or racial groups in a society have equal rights and opportunities, and none is ignored or regarded as unimportant.
- Multiculturalism in communication: Verbal and written interaction involving two or more participants who have different cultural values and beliefs.
- International business requires multicultural communication, the sharing written & oral information between business people from different countries.



3.1 Guidelines for effective multi/cross-cultural communication

1. Define acronyms and abbreviations

This can be done in the following ways:

- Parenthetically
- In a sentence
- In a glossary

Instead of CIA

Write CIA (cash in advance) or cash in advance (CIA)

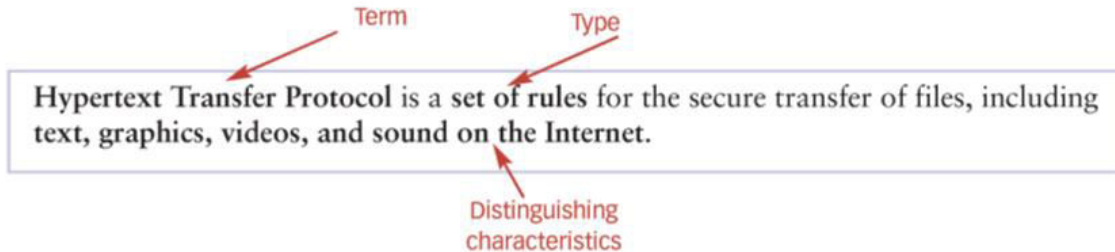
If you have too many acronyms and abbreviations or technical jargon, go with a glossary of terms



Definition

If you provide your definition in a sentence follow the pattern:

Term + Type + Distinguishing features



Provide examples

Extended definitions of one or more paragraphs

In addition to term, type and features, provide examples, procedures and descriptions

A video card (graphics accelerator card, display adapter, or graphics card) is a type of printed circuit board that can be inserted into an expansion slot of a computer's motherboard. The video card creates and outputs images to a display. Functions of a video card can include video capture, MPEG-2 and MPEG-4 decoding, TV output, or the ability to connect multiple monitors.

A glossary is an alphabetized list of terms placed after your conclusion/recommendations or in some cases in the beginning of your report

GLOSSARY

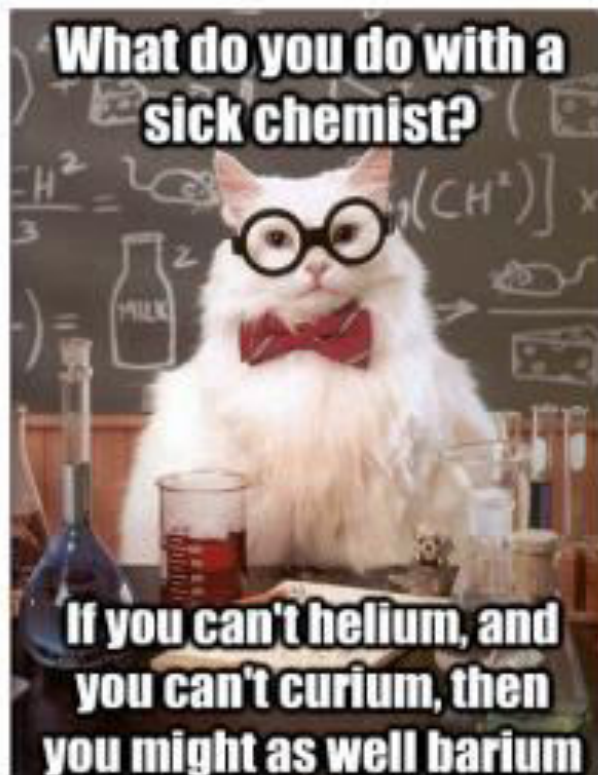
ADC	analog to digital converter
Analog	a variable signal continuous in both time and amplitude
DAC	digital to analog converter
LAN	local area network
PSTN	Public Switched Telephone Network—analog phone systems
ROI	return on investment
Voice signal	allows users to access phone options with a single voice command
VoIP	voice over Internet protocol
WAN	wide area network

2. Avoid jargons and idioms

(especially when you know that audience is non-technical)

ballpark figure	eye on the prize
belt-tightening	face the music
bite the bullet	guesstimate
brownie points	jump through hoops
buck stops here	pass the buck
crunch time	pull the plug
dog-eat-dog world	shape up or ship out
drum up business	through the roof

3. Avoid humor and puns



4. Avoid figurative language



Someone Needs To Teach Her
About Figurative Language

Look for cultural biases/ expectations

Different colors and images represent different meanings across cultures

- The color red

Be careful when using slashmarks

slash mark mean “and,” “or,” or both “and/or”?

USE SIMPLE GRAPHICS TO REPRESENT PEOPLE

Use simple, abstract, even stick figures to represent people

Be Careful with numbers, dates and time

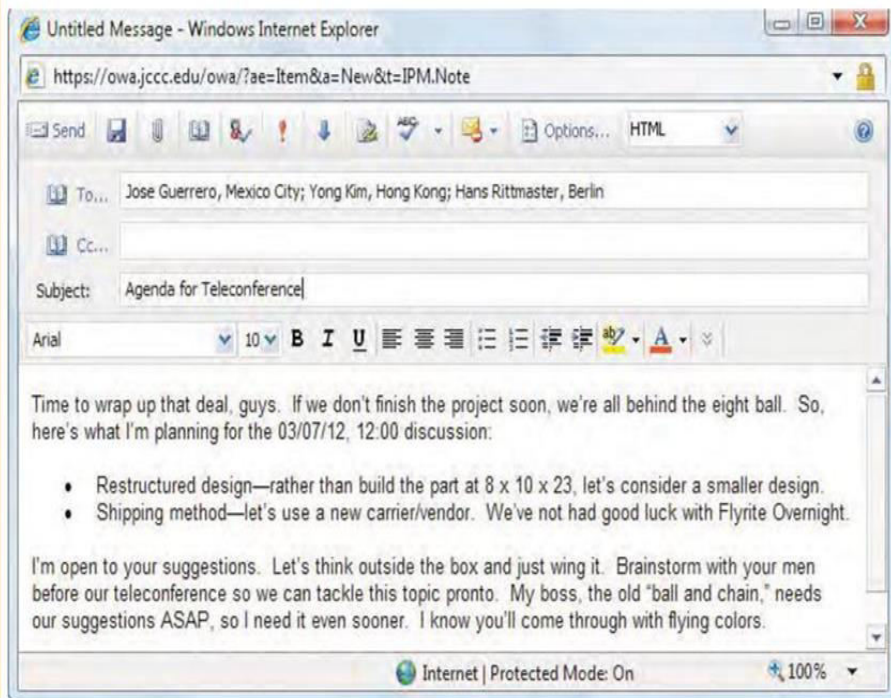
TABLE 4.6 Different Ways of Understanding and Writing the U.S. Date 05/03/12

Country	Date
United States	May 3, 2012
United Kingdom	March 5, 2012
France	5 mars 2012
Germany	5. Marz 2012
Sweden	12-05-03
Italy	5.3.12

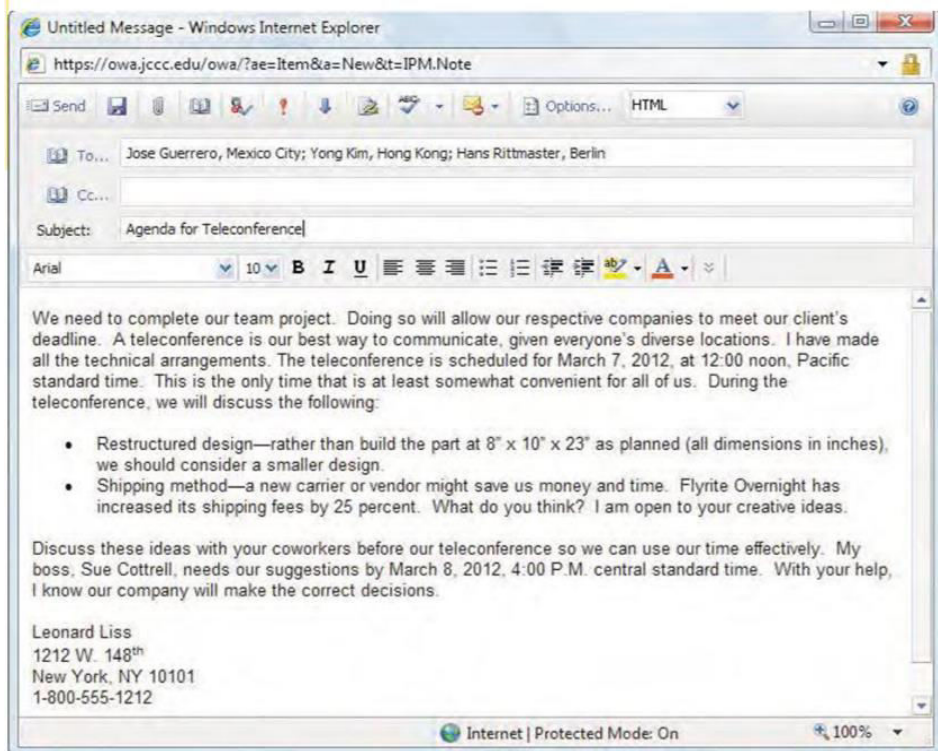
TABLE 4.7 Different Ways of Writing the U.S. Time 5:15 P.M.

Country	Time
United States	5:15 P.M.
France	17:15
Germany	17.15
Quebec, Canada	17 h 15

BEFORE



AFTER



Avoid biased language

Ageist language

BEFORE

Professor Jones, an elderly teacher at State University, is publishing a textbook despite his age.

AFTER

Professor Jones, a State University teacher, is publishing a textbook.

“Elderly” could imply feebleness

Avoid reference to age when possible

If not, use words like “people over 60” or “retirees”

Avoid biased language about people with disabilities

Instead of handicap, disability is the politically correct term

Avoid reference to a person's disabilities

Debbie Brown, a blind market researcher, won the employee of the year

Debbie Brown, a market researcher, won the employee of the year

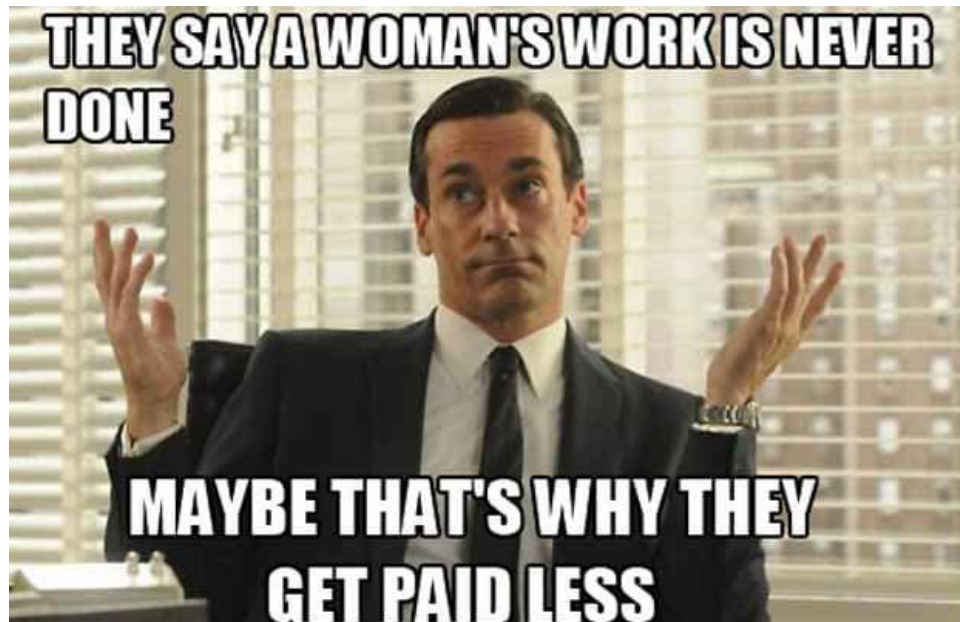
John suffers from diabetes

John is diabetic

Nancy is confined to a wheelchair

Nancy uses a wheelchair

Avoid sexist language



BEFORE

Biased

The CEO of Yahoo is a woman named Carol A. Bartz.

When setting up his experiment, the researcher must always check for errors.

As we acquired scientific knowledge, men began to examine long-held ideas more critically.

AFTER

Unbiased

The CEO of Yahoo is Carol A. Bartz.

When setting up experiments, the researcher must always check for errors.

As we acquired scientific knowledge, people began to examine long-held ideas more critically.

Modifiers that describe women in physical terms not applied to men treat women unequally.

BEFORE

Biased

The poor women could no longer go on; the exhausted men . . .

Mrs. Acton, a gorgeous blonde, is Joe Granger's assistant.

AFTER

Unbiased

The exhausted men and women could no longer go on.

Jan Acton is Joe Granger's assistant.

Avoid stereotyping



BEFORE

Biased

Current tax regulations allow a head of household to deduct for the support of his children.

The manager is responsible for the productivity of his department; the foreman is responsible for the work of his linemen.

The administrative assistant brought her boss his coffee.

The teacher must be sure her lesson plans are filed.

AFTER

Unbiased

Current tax regulations allow a head of household to deduct for child support.

Management is responsible for departmental productivity. Supervisors are responsible for their personnel.

The administrative assistant brought the boss's coffee.

The teacher must file all lesson plans.

Pronouns

BEFORE

Biased

Sometimes the doctor calls on his patients in their homes.

The typical child does his homework after school.

A good lawyer will make sure that his clients are aware of their rights.

AFTER

Unbiased

Sometimes the doctor calls on patients in their homes.

Most children do their homework after school.

A good lawyer will make sure that clients are aware of their rights.

BEFORE

Biased

Sometimes the doctor calls on his patients in their homes.

The typical child does his homework after school.

A good lawyer will make sure that his clients are aware of their rights.

Gender Tagges Nouns

BEFORE

Gender-tagged, Biased Nouns

mankind
manpower
the common man
wise men
businessmen
policemen
firemen
foreman
chairman
stewardess/steward
waitress/waiter

AFTER

Unbiased

people
workers, personnel
the average citizen
leaders
businesspeople
police officers
firefighters
supervisor
chairperson, chair
flight attendant
server

Audience Involvement

Personalized tone

Use a personalized, collaborative tone to involve your reader

Especially effective for social media

Personal pronouns humanize the text

Pronoun		Focus
You	}	The reader
Your		
We	}	The team
Us		
Our		
I	}	The ego
Me		
My	}	

BEFORE

Claims Procedure

To obtain service under the Emissions Performance Warranty, take the vehicle to the company dealer as soon as possible after it fails an I/M test along with documentation showing that the vehicle failed an EPA-approved emissions test.

Without any pronouns, the version has no personality. It's dull and stiff, and it reads as if no human beings are involved.

Compare this flat, dry, dehumanized example with the more personalized version.

AFTER

Claims Procedure

How do you get service under the Emissions Performance Warranty? To get service under this warranty, take your car to the dealer as soon as possible after it has failed an EPA-approved test. Be sure to bring along the document that shows your car failed the test.

When pronouns are added in this version, the writing involves the reader on a personal level.

Use positive words

POSITIVE WORDS

accomplish	effective	organize	thank you
achieve	efficient	plan	value
advantage	enjoy	please	
appreciate	ensure	produce	
asset	establish	profit	
assist	favorable	promote	
benefit	guide	raise	
build	happy	recommend	
confident	help	reduce	
coordinate	improve	satisfy	
create	increase	serve	
develop	lead	succeed	
educate	maintain	support	

BEFORE

Negative

- We cannot process your request. You failed to follow the printed instructions.
- The error is your fault. You keep your books incorrectly and cannot complain about our deliveries. If you would cooperate with us, we could solve your problem.
- We have received your letter complaining about our services.
- Your bill is now three weeks overdue. Failure to pay immediately will result in lower credit ratings.
- The invoice you sent was useless by the time it arrived. You wasted my time and money.

AFTER

Positive

- So that we may process your request rapidly, please fill in line 6 on the printed form.
- To ensure prompt deliveries, let's get together to review our bookkeeping practices. Would next Tuesday be convenient?
- Thank you for writing to us about our services.
- If you're as busy as we are, you've probably misplaced our recent bill (mailed three weeks ago). Please send it in soon to maintain your high credit ratings.
- We're proud of our ability to maintain schedules. But we need your help. When you return invoices by the fifteenth, we save time and you save money.

EXAMPLE ►

This e-mail achieves audience involvement by speaking directly to the reader ("Renata"), by using pronouns, and by employing positive words to motivate the reader to action.

To: Renata Shuklaper

Subject: Assignment of Contract Administration Project

Renata, thank you for accepting the Contract Administration Project. To accomplish our goal of competitive bidding, I need your help. Please follow these guidelines with your team:

1. Analyze other operating companies to see how they ensure neutrality when administering contracts.
2. Coordinate our consultants to guarantee that they achieve impartiality.
3. Develop standards for all operating procedures across all departments.
4. Prepare a report for our advisory team. They'll need it by the end of the month.

Your successful completion of this project, Renata, will help us improve future contract administrations. I'm confident that you'll do a great job, and I know our company and employees will benefit.

Class activity

Achieving Audience Involvement

1. Revise the following sentences to achieve audience involvement through personalization, adding pronouns and names.
 - a. The company will require further information before processing this request.
 - b. It has been decided that a new procedure must be implemented to avoid further mechanical failures.
 - c. The department supervisor wants to extend heartfelt thanks for the fine efforts expended.
 - d. I think you have done a great job. I want you to know that you have surpassed this month's quota by 12 percent. I believe I can speak for the entire department by saying thank you.
 - e. If the computer overloads, simultaneously press Reset and Control. Wait for the screen command. If it reads "Data Recovered," continue operations. If it reads "I/O Error," call the computer resource center.
2. Revise the following sentences to achieve reader benefit, using positive words.
 - a. We cannot lay your cable until you sign the attached waiver.
 - b. John, don't purchase the wrong program. If we continue to keep inefficient records, our customers will continue to complain.
 - c. You have not paid your bill yet. Failure to do so might result in termination of services.
 - d. If you incorrectly quote and paraphrase, you will receive an *F* on the assignment.
 - e. Your team has lost 6 of their last 12 games.

Sources

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